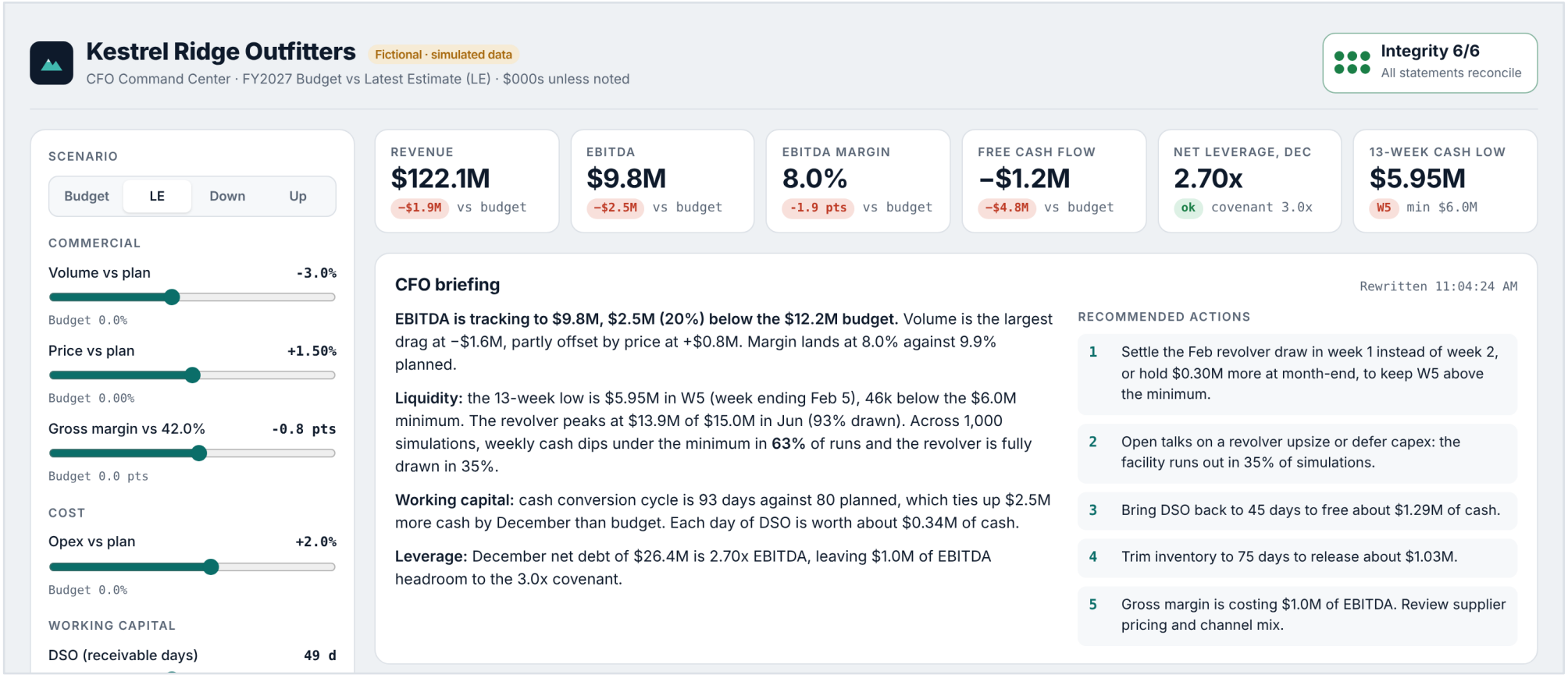
CFO Command Center

How the AI-built finance model works

Kestrel Ridge Outfitters (fictional) · AI Playground demo · November 2026

One page holds a full finance model that recalculates live



What you see: scenario sliders on the left, headline KPIs, a self-writing CFO briefing, and the integrity badge (top right). Below the fold: EBITDA bridge, 13-week cash forecast, Monte Carlo, the three statements and the checks.

Nine drivers feed one model, and the model feeds every view

Inputs

- Sales: volume, price, gross margin
- Cost: operating expenses
- Working capital: DSO, DIO, DPO
- Capital: capex, interest rate
- Plus a fixed opening balance sheet

The model

- Income statement
- Balance sheet
- Cash flow statement
- Revolver (credit line) policy
- 12 months in $000s, under 1 ms per run

Outputs

- KPIs vs budget
- EBITDA bridge
- 13-week cash forecast
- 1,000 Monte Carlo runs
- CFO briefing and actions
- 6 integrity checks

Move any slider and the whole chain reruns instantly. No number on the page is typed in by hand.

The nine sliders are the only inputs to the model

Slider	What it means	Budget	Latest estimate
Volume vs plan	How many more or fewer units we sell	0%	−3.0%
Price vs plan	Average selling price change	0%	+1.5%
Gross margin	Points above or below the 42% plan	0 pts	−0.8 pts
Opex vs plan	Change in operating costs	0%	+2.0%
DSO	Days customers take to pay us	45	49
DIO	Days stock sits before it is sold	75	82
DPO	Days we take to pay suppliers	40	38
Capex vs plan	Capital spending vs the $450k/month plan	100%	100%
Interest rate shift	Change to the 7.25% borrowing rate	0 bps	+50 bps

Presets load a full set at once: Budget, Latest estimate (LE), Downside and Upside.

The three statements are linked, so they must agree

Income statement

Revenue = plan × volume × price. Costs follow margin and opex. Ends in net income.

→

Cash flow statement

Net income + depreciation − change in working capital − capex − debt repayments and dividends.

→

Balance sheet

Cash, receivables, inventory and fixed assets = payables, debt and equity.

1 **Net income → equity**

Retained earnings go up by net income and down by dividends each month.

2 **Cash flow → cash**

Closing cash on the cash flow statement becomes balance-sheet cash.

3 **Days → working capital**

Receivables = revenue × DSO ÷ 30. Inventory and payables work the same way.

Revolver rule: if month-end cash would fall below the $7.5M target, borrow (up to $15M); any extra cash repays it.

Six automatic checks prove the numbers tie out

Balance sheet balances

Assets = liabilities + equity at every month-end

Cash ties to balance sheet

Cash flow closing cash = balance-sheet cash

Retained earnings roll forward

Opening + net income − dividends = closing

Direct = indirect cash flow

Receipts − payments = NI + D&A − working capital

EBITDA bridge reconciles

Budget + volume + price + margin + opex = LE

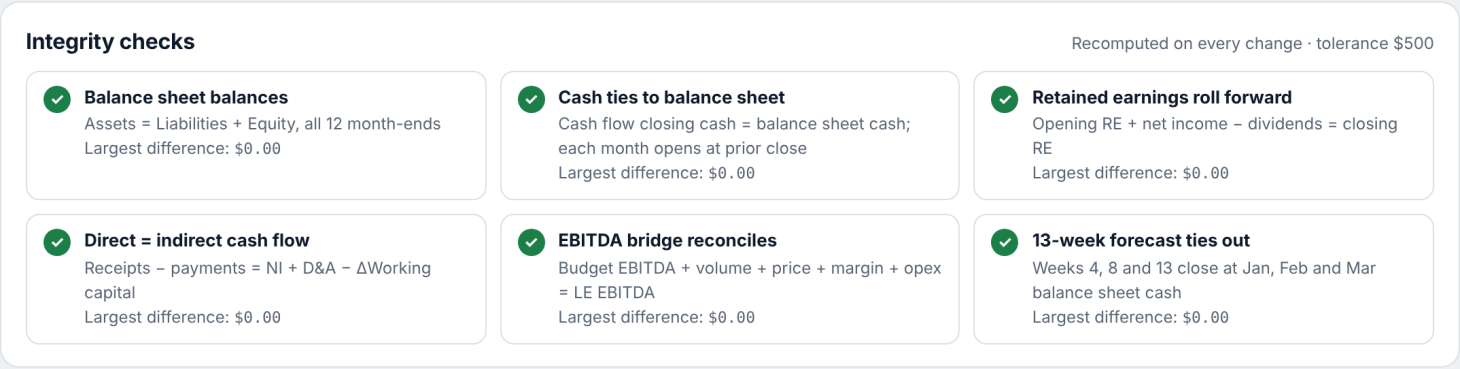
13-week forecast ties out

Weeks 4, 8 and 13 equal Jan, Feb, Mar cash

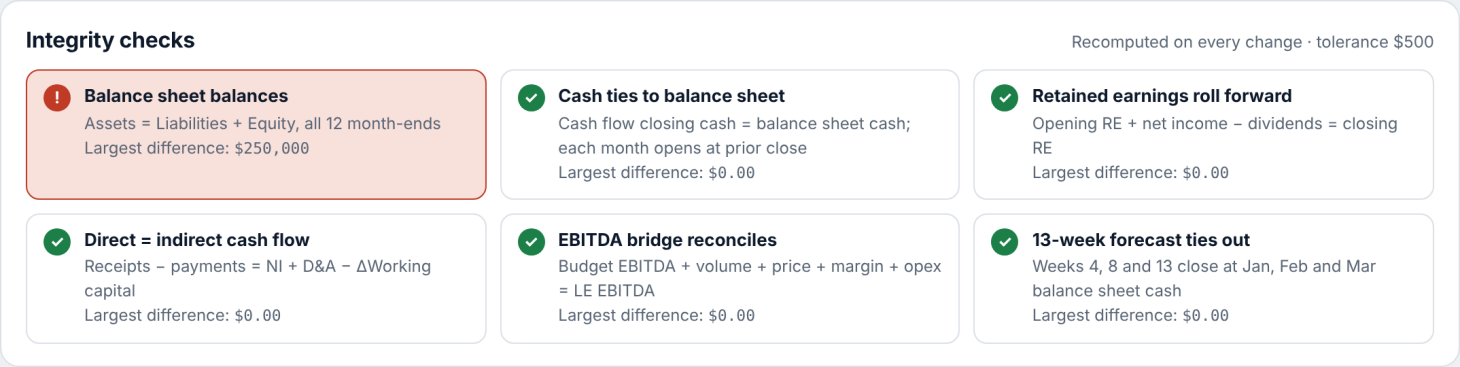
They rerun after every change. The largest difference across all checks is under one cent.

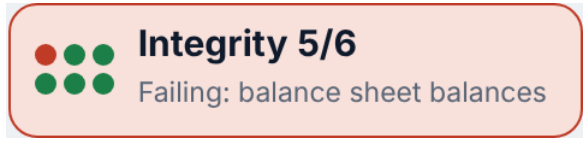
Typing over one number turns the badge red

Before: all six checks pass



After: June receivables typed over by +$250k





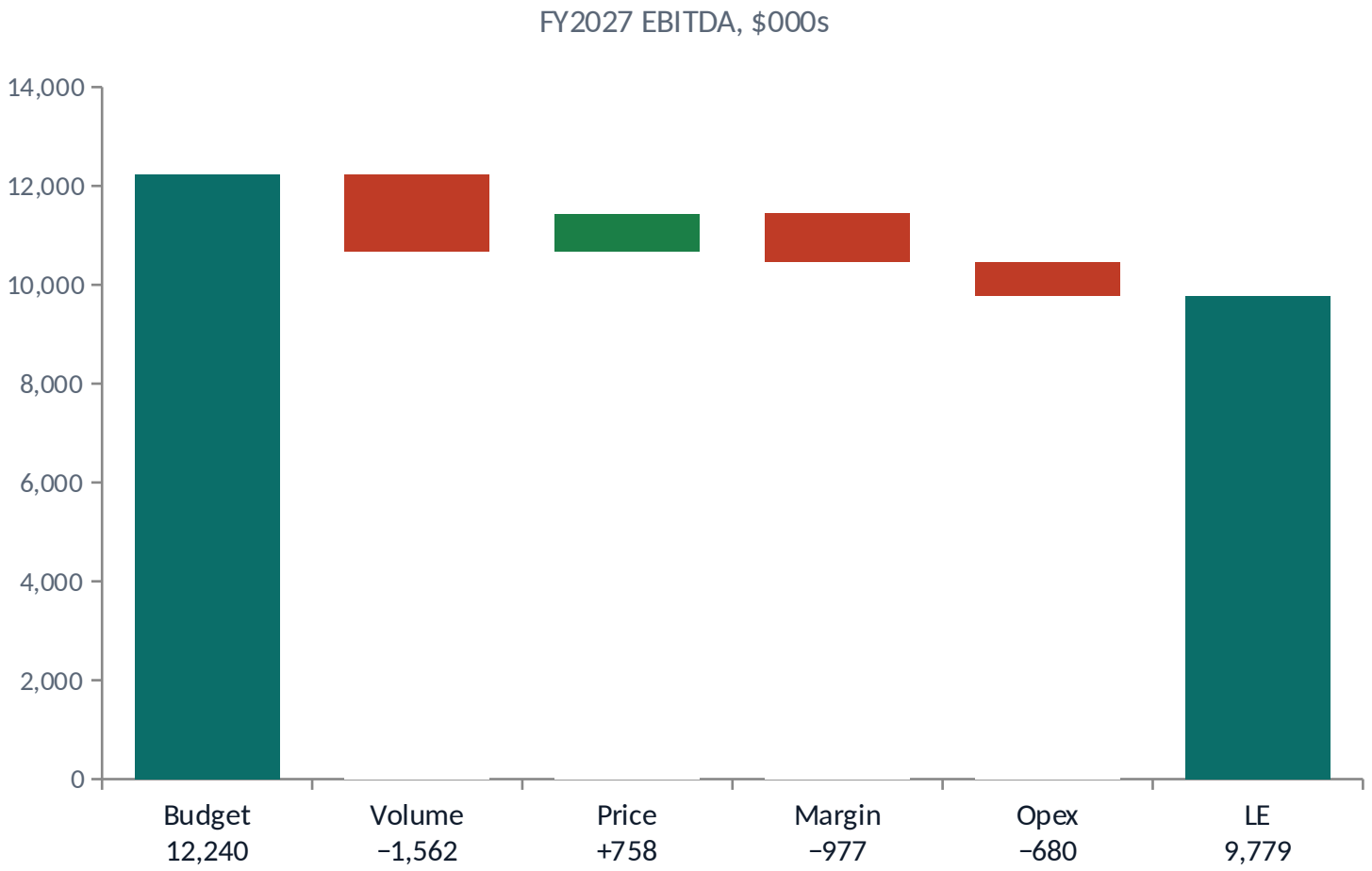
What the switch does

Adds $250k to June receivables without flowing it through cash or equity, like a hard-coded cell in Excel.

Why it matters

Typed-over numbers are the most common spreadsheet error. Here the model catches it and the briefing warns the numbers are unreliable.

Lower volume is the biggest reason EBITDA misses budget

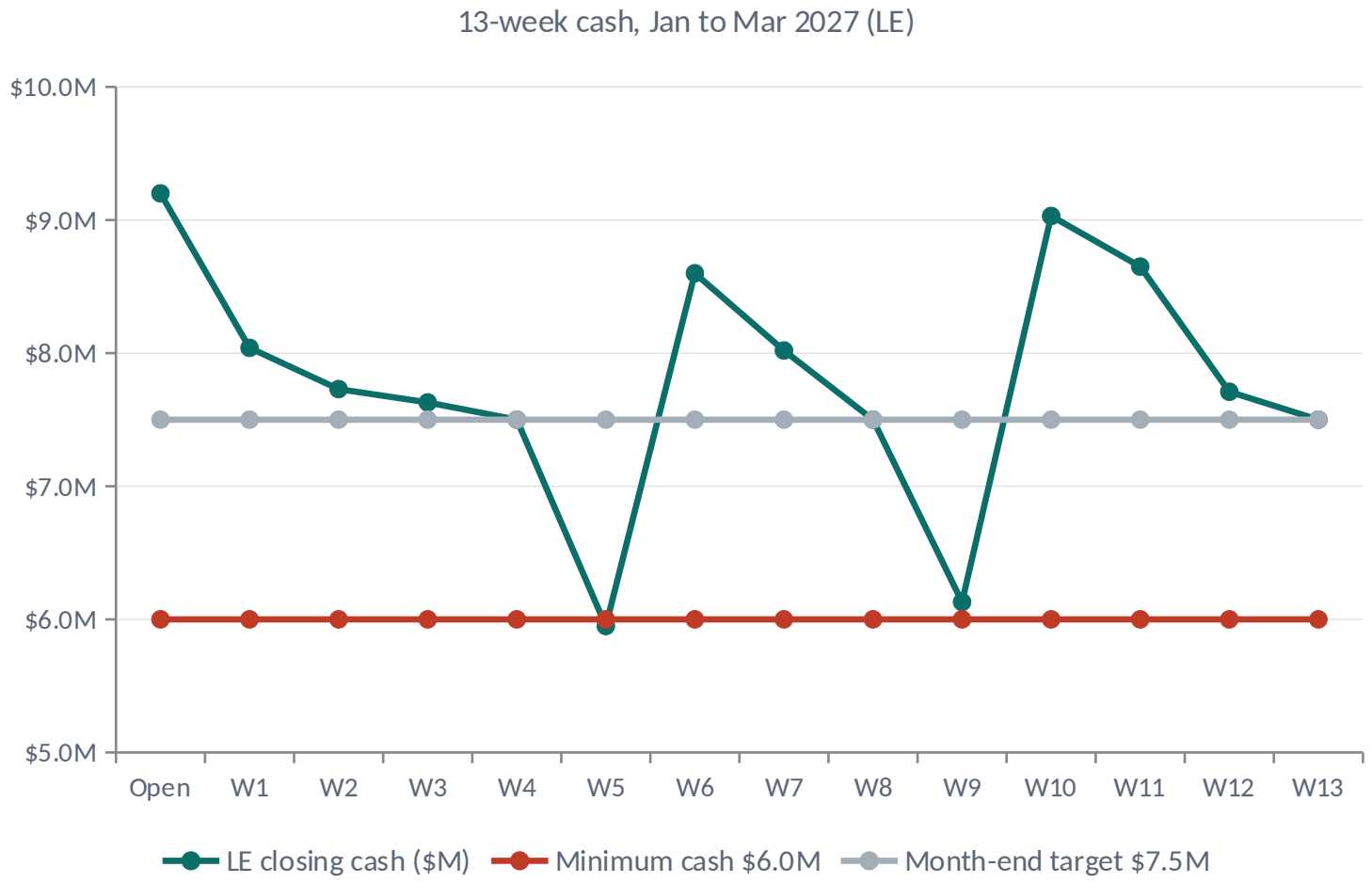


$2.5M

EBITDA shortfall vs budget (−20%)

- Volume −3% costs $1.6M of gross profit.
- A 1.5% price rise gives back $0.8M.
- 0.8 pts lower margin costs $1.0M.
- Opex 2% over plan costs $0.7M.

Cash dips below the minimum mid-month, not at month-end



$5.95M

Low point, week 5 (w/e Feb 5)

- Customers mostly pay late in the month.
- Suppliers are paid in weeks 1 and 3; payroll every two weeks.
- Revolver cash arrives in week 2, so the first week of each month is the pinch.
- **Fix: draw in week 1, or hold more cash at month-end.**

1,000 simulations turn one forecast into a range of outcomes

63%

of runs dip below the $6.0M minimum in some week

35%

of runs fully use the $15M credit line

$5.72M

1-in-10 worst weekly cash low (P10)

$7.0–12.6M

FY EBITDA range, P10 to P90

Shake the inputs

Each run nudges volume, price, margin, opex and the day counts randomly around your slider values.

Add demand noise

Each month gets its own random ±3% wobble in sales.

Rerun everything

The full model and 13-week forecast run 1,000 times, in about 30 ms.

Figures shown are for the Latest estimate preset. "Re-run" on the page draws a fresh set of 1,000.

The CFO briefing is written by rules, not by a chatbot

Example output (LE)

"EBITDA is tracking to $9.8M, $2.5M (20%) below the $12.2M budget. Volume is the largest drag at −$1.6M, partly offset by price at +$0.8M."

"Leverage of 2.70x leaves $1.0M of EBITDA headroom to the 3.0x covenant."

How it decides what to say

If the biggest bridge bar → becomes the headline driver

If the lowest week is below $6.0M → suggests drawing the revolver earlier

If DSO is above 45 days → shows the cash freed by collecting faster

If DIO is above 75 days → shows the cash freed by cutting stock

If leverage is above 2.75x → flags covenant risk

A two-minute live demo

1 — Start on LE

Point at the badge (6/6) and read the first briefing sentence.

2 — Click Down

EBITDA falls, leverage breaches 3.0x, the briefing rewrites itself.

3 — Drag DSO to 60

Watch the cash chart and actions update instantly.

4 — Tick "Type over a cell"

The badge turns red at 5/6. This is the money shot.

5 — Untick and click Re-run

Fresh 1,000 simulations; the badge is green again.

Tip: open the link in an incognito window first to confirm colleagues can see it.

Questions colleagues are likely to ask

Is this real company data?

No. Kestrel Ridge is fictional and every number is simulated.

Is AI running while I use it?

No. Claude wrote the code; the maths is plain JavaScript in the browser.

How long did it take?

A few prompts in one session, plus checking the output.

Could we use it on our numbers?

Yes, with care: swap the drivers and opening balance sheet, then review every formula.

Why trust the numbers?

Six accounting checks rerun on every change and must all pass.

What are its limits?

Simplified tax and debt terms, no prior-year history. It is a demo, not an audited model.

AI built the model. Accounting logic keeps it honest.

Nine inputs · three linked statements · six live checks · 1,000 simulations

Try it: link in #ai-playground